



Debatable: Ottniel Baartman of South Africa celebrates after dismissing Mahmudullah Riyad of Bangladesh which was later given not out on review, but the ball went off his leg-guards for a boundary. While Mahmudullah survived, no leg byes were given to his team. The debate, therefore, was whether the four leg byes should have been credited or not. Eventually, Bangladesh lost by just four runs, so the debate only got heated. AFP

There were no reviews for any decision those days, but be that as it may, if dead ball starts to be part of the referrals for batters and the fielding side, the rhythm and flow of the game will be upset considerably. I strongly believe that referrals should be only for dismissals given or not given. **These have a huge impact on the result of the game and not reviews for wide balls or no balls.** They only

waste time and lengthen the game.

India will play Australia in their final game of the Super Eight and that could well decide who gets to the semifinals. In all the ICC events in recent times, India has played well but have slipped just when the trophy is within reach. It's like a batter who has got into the nineties but can't get to the coveted century mark. Will this time be different? Let's pray that it will be so.



Speaking of dead balls, I remember how when we were chasing the target of 438 set by England at The Oval in 1979 there were at least three occasions when a dead ball for not offering a stroke was called after we had taken three runs each time.